



Department of Economics
ECON 201: Principles of Microeconomics
Fall 2026

Instruction modality: In-person

Class and exam location: SGMH 1506

Class days and time: Monday and Wednesday, 1:00–2:15 PM

Course website: dbhagia.com/econ201

Instructor: Div Bhagia

Office: SGMH 3361

Email: dbhagia@fullerton.edu

Phone: (657) 278-2914

Office hours: Wednesday, 2:30–5:15 PM, or by appointment (in-person or on [Zoom](#))

Technical Problems

If you encounter any technical difficulties, contact the instructor immediately to document the problem. Then, contact: [student IT help desk](#), [email](#), phone = 657-278-8888, walk-in [Student Genius Center](#), online chat - log into [Portal](#); click “Online IT Help”; click “Live Chat.” For issues with Canvas: Canvas Support Hotline = 657-278-8888, [search the CSUF Canvas Guides with AI Assistant](#), or [report a problem](#).

Response Time

I usually respond to emails or LMS messages within 48 hours (excluding weekends or holidays).

Course Communication

All course announcements and individual emails are sent through CANVAS, which only uses CSUF email accounts. Therefore, you MUST check your CSUF email on a regular basis (several times a week) for the duration of the course.

Course Information

Prerequisites

None.

University Catalog Description

Principles of individual consumer and producer decision-making in various market structures, the price system, market performance and government policy.

Additional Course Description

For most of human history, living standards barely changed. Then, beginning around 1700, they took off, first in Britain and then across much of the world. Behind this take-off was a new way of organizing economic life, capitalism, built on private property, markets, and firms. This course is about the nuts and bolts of how that system works.

We build the core tools of microeconomics and use them to answer everyday questions along the way: Why are almost all the big brands in the grocery store owned by ten companies? Why does Cheerios cost more than the store brand sitting right next to it, and why do people keep buying it anyway? When bird flu sent egg prices soaring, were companies profiting or just surviving? If the government taxes gasoline, who bears the burden, the oil companies or you? Is capping rent to make housing affordable a good idea? Why do we end up with more pollution than anyone actually wants? And why do some things, like parks and street cleaning, need to be provided by the government instead of businesses?

Withdrawal Deadlines

The deadline to drop this class without a “W” is *Tuesday, September 8, 2026*. Authorization to withdraw after September 8 shall be granted only for the most serious and compelling reasons, e.g., a documented physical, medical, emotional, or other condition that limits the student’s full participation in the class. Poor academic performance, e.g., lack of effort or poor attendance, is not evidence of a serious reason for withdrawal.

Student Learning Outcomes

Core Topics

1. Opportunity cost and specialization (ie. gains from trade)
2. Demand, supply, and equilibrium

3. Elasticity
4. Economic surplus and efficiency
5. Government interventions
6. Production, cost, and profit-maximization
7. Market structure

Learning Objectives

Upon successful completion of this course, students will be able to:

1. Understand how to measure opportunity cost and apply it to determine optimal choices or trade-offs
2. Determine a predicted market equilibrium using information from graphs or tables describing demand and supply decisions
3. Calculate elasticities (own price, income, or cross-price) using price and quantity data
4. Understand how to measure economic surplus and apply it to determine the efficiency of trades or transactions
5. Use the supply and demand model to predict the equilibrium effects of government interventions in markets
6. Calculate marginal products and marginal costs, and use this information to determine profit-maximizing decisions
7. Understand the characteristics related to market structures (perfect competition, monopoly, monopolistic competition, oligopoly)

General Education

ECON 201 satisfies *General Education Area 4A, Introduction to the Social and Behavioral Sciences*. Per UPS 411.201, students completing courses in subarea 4A shall:

1. Understand the purpose of the social sciences and the distinguishing features of the social sciences
2. Understand and explain major social science concepts, methods, and theories and apply them to concrete problems of contemporary society
3. Reflect on what it means to be a social, historical, cultural, psychological, and political being

4. Reflect on their own social, cultural, and political experiences in light of social science concepts, methods, and theories
5. Understand the integrated nature of social, political, and economic behaviors and institutions in different geographical and historical contexts
6. Understand processes of social, political, and cultural change and differentiation in a variety of cultural contexts

As a GE course, ECON 201 includes a *writing requirement*. This is met by the two-part writing assignment, worth 15% of the course grade and described under Grading Policies and Standards below. You will receive careful and timely feedback on Part 1 in time to improve your writing for Part 2, and the evaluation of your writing counts toward your final course grade.

Required Texts

The required textbook for this course is *The Economy 2.0: Microeconomics* by CORE Econ. The complete textbook is *free and open access*, available online at:

<https://books.core-econ.org/the-economy/microeconomics.html>

The online edition is the version I will refer to in class, and it is all you need. If you prefer reading on paper, a printed paperback is available from the publisher (Hackett, ISBN 978-1-64792-160-6). Assigned sections from the textbook are listed in the course schedule at the end of this syllabus. Lecture slides, worksheets, and practice problems will be posted on the course website.

Conduct in the Classroom

Use of phones, laptops, or other digital devices is not allowed during the lecture, except when explicitly instructed to do so. Randomized Controlled Trials (RCTs) conducted at West Point show that in-class computer use inhibits learning. Here is a [link](#) to the paper. Tablets used for taking notes that remain flat on the desk are allowed.

Grading Policies and Standards

Grading Scale

In this course, the plus/minus system will be used. The grade breakdown is as follows:

98–100% = A+

93–97.99% = A (outstanding performance)

90–92.99% = A-

87–89.99% = B+

83–86.99% = B (good performance)

80–82.99% = B-

77–79.99% = C+

73–76.99% = C (acceptable performance)

70–72.99% = C-

67–69.99% = D+

63–66.99% = D (poor performance)

60–62.99% = D-

0–59.99% = F

Economics majors and CBE majors must earn a grade of C or higher in this course to receive credit toward their degree.

Grade Breakdown

Your grade will be determined according to the following breakdown:

Assignment	Percentage
Writing assignment, Part 1	5
Writing assignment, Part 2	10
Quizzes (8 in class, lowest 2 dropped)	30
Midterm 1	15
Midterm 2	15
Final Exam (cumulative)	25
Total	100

Attendance and Participation

While not separately graded, regular attendance and participation are required to succeed in this course. Missing class means missing quizzes and the in-class worksheet practice that exams draw on. Extended absences will therefore negatively affect your performance, so reach out if you have concerns about your ability to participate.

Examinations

Exams are given in person on the dates in the course schedule. These dates are fixed. Exams are closed-book and closed-note and include a combination of multiple-choice and short-answer questions. The final exam is *cumulative*.

Requests for re-evaluation of graded material must be made within one week of the return of the assignment. All requests must be accompanied by a written explanation of your dispute. It is your responsibility to consult any posted rubrics or keys prior to making a re-grade request.

Assignment Descriptions

- **Writing Assignment:** You will complete a writing assignment in two parts, worth 5% and 10% of your final grade. You will receive feedback on the first part and should use it to improve the second. Due dates are listed in the course schedule, and detailed instructions and the grading rubric will be posted on the course website closer to each deadline.
- **Practice Problems:** Each week, I post a set of practice problems on the course website, along with full solutions. They are *not collected or graded*, but you should attempt them each week to keep pace with the course and to do well on quizzes. Work them on your own before looking at the solutions because reading a worked solution feels like understanding, whereas working the problem produces it. You are welcome to work through the problems with classmates and come to office hours for help.
- **Quizzes:** There are *eight quizzes*, together worth 30% of the course grade and weighted equally. They are given in class on the days marked in the course schedule, typically Mondays. Each takes about 10 minutes at the start of class and covers the preceding week of class. These are checkpoints to make sure you are keeping up, and the questions are similar to the practice problems and to what we do in class. *The two lowest quiz scores are dropped*, which covers the ordinary reasons you might miss a quiz or have an off day, **so there are no make-up quizzes in any circumstances.**

Extra credit

There are no extra credit options in this course.

Make-up and late submission policy

Make-up exams will only be offered under very limited circumstances. It is your responsibility to notify me either in advance or within 24 hours of missing an exam. There are no make-up quizzes; the two dropped quiz scores serve as the make-up policy.

For the writing assignment, work submitted after the due date will incur a 10% per day penalty, up to a maximum of 50%. Communicate with me immediately if you encounter a problem that may affect your ability to submit work on time.

Generative AI Policy

You may use generative AI tools as a *tutor*, and I encourage it for that purpose. Asking an AI tool to explain a concept a different way, to walk you through a practice problem, or to quiz you before an exam is a good use of your time.

You may *not* submit AI-generated text as your own writing, and you may not use AI to produce answers you could not reconstruct and explain yourself. On the writing assignment you must include a brief note describing how you used AI tools, if at all. An honest description of substantial use is not penalized; an undisclosed one is a violation of academic integrity.

Alternative procedures for submitting work

In case of technical difficulties with CANVAS or other online resources, I will communicate with students directly through CSUF email and will provide directions on alternative methods for submitting work and/or may extend submission deadlines. If email is not available, students may contact the department office for guidance.

Authentication of student work

All assignments submitted for a grade in this class must be your individual work unless otherwise indicated. Student work will be authenticated by submission in class for in-person work and through Canvas for work submitted online.

Retention of student work

Work submitted for a grade in this course, either as a hardcopy or through the CANVAS course site, shall be retained for a reasonable time after the semester is completed, not to exceed the last day of the subsequent semester. Exam material is exempt from this policy; however, students have the right to review their work in the presence of the faculty member.

Academic Integrity

It is expected that any work submitted for a grade in this course will be the sole product of the individual student, unless otherwise permitted. Presenting work from other sources as your own is unacceptable and will result in a notification to the Dean of Students of a violation of campus standards. Behaviors that seek to gain an unfair advantage or negatively impact the ability of others to learn will also result in a report to the Dean of Students.

The consequences for cheating or other actions contrary to CSUF student conduct policies can be severe. Communicate with me if you find yourself in a situation that might lead to a poor decision.

You are encouraged to use the resources provided in this course. The use of sites, including but not limited to Chegg and Course Hero, which require subscriptions and provide solutions to homework problems, exam questions, etc., is explicitly prohibited in this course and is considered academic dishonesty.

Working together is encouraged. Study groups, working through practice problems with classmates, and discussing worksheet questions in class are all good ways to learn. However, any sharing of assignments, even if only intended to help, or using communication tools for unauthorized collaboration, is considered academic dishonesty. Unless otherwise explicitly stated, assignments and examinations must be completed on your own.

Technical Requirements

Students are expected to

1. Have basic computer competency which includes:
 - (a) The ability to use a personal computer to locate, create, move, copy, delete, name, rename, and save files and folders on hard drives, secondary storage devices such as USB drives, and cloud such as Google Drive (Titan Apps) and Dropbox
 - (b) The ability to use a word processing program to create, edit, format, store, retrieve, and print documents
 - (c) The ability to use their CSUF email accounts to receive, create, edit, print, save, and send an e-mail message with and without an attached file
 - (d) The ability to use an Internet browser such as Chrome, Safari, Firefox, or Microsoft® Edge to search and access web sites in the World Wide Web

2. Have ongoing reliable access to a computer with Internet connectivity for regular course assignments
3. Utilize updated version of Microsoft® Office (for P.C. or Mac) including Word, PowerPoint, and Excel to learn content and communicate with colleagues and faculty; have the ability to regularly print assignments
4. Maintain and access their CSUF student email account at least three times weekly
5. Use Internet search and retrieval skills to complete assignments
6. Apply their educational technology skills to complete expected competencies
7. Utilize other software applications as course requirements dictate
8. Utilize the LMS to access course materials and complete assignments

CBE Assessment Statement

The programs offered in the College of Business and Economics (CBE) at Cal State Fullerton are designed to provide every student with the knowledge and skills essential for a successful career in business. Since assessment plays a vital role in the college's drive to offer the best, several assessment tools are implemented to constantly evaluate our program as well as our students' progress. Students, faculty, and staff should expect to participate in CBE assessment activities. In doing so, the college can measure its strengths and weaknesses and continue cultivating a climate of excellence in its students and programs.

Assurance of Learning (AoL) is an integral part of both our AACSB and WASC accreditation. Please visit the [Assessment and Instructional Support website](#) for more information on our college-based assurance of learning efforts.

College and University Learning Resources

Wall Street Journal

You get a FREE subscription to the Wall Street Journal through the University. Activate your school-sponsored membership here: WSJ.com/ActivateCSUF.

University Learning Center

The goal of the University Learning Center is to provide all CSUF students with academic support in an inviting and contemporary environment. The staff of the University Learning Center will assist students with their academic assignments, general study skills, and computer user needs. The ULC staff work with all students from diverse backgrounds in most undergraduate general education courses, including those in science and math, humanities and social sciences, as well as other subjects. They offer one-to-one peer tutoring, online writing review, and many more services. More information can be found on the University Learning Center website.

Writing Center

The Writing Center offers 30-minute, one-on-one peer tutoring sessions and workshops aimed at providing assistance for all written assignments and student writing concerns. Writing Center services are available to students from all disciplines. Registration and appointment schedules are available at the Writing Center Appointment Scheduling System. Walk-in appointments are also available on a first-come, first-served basis to students who have registered online. More information can be found at the Writing Center webpage. The Writing Center is located on the first floor of the Pollak Library. Their phone number is (657) 278-3650.

Student Resources Website

It is the student's responsibility to read and understand the required and important [student information for course syllabi](#). Included is information about:

- University learning goals
- General Education learning objectives
- Netiquette/appropriate online behavior
- Students' rights to accommodations
- Campus student support resources
- Academic integrity
- Emergency preparedness/what to do
- Library services
- Student IT services and competencies
- Software privacy and accessibility
- Accessibility statement

- Diversity statement
- Land acknowledgement
- Final exam schedule
- Semester calendar

When you need help immediately or to report a dangerous situation, call 911. University Police non-emergency line: (657) 278-2515.

Tentative Course Schedule

Module	Date	Lec.	Topic	Reading	Due
The Big Picture	Mon 8/24	1	Introduction to the course		
	Wed 8/26	2	The capitalist takeoff: Prosperity and its shadows	1.1–1.5; 1.8–1.10	
The Economist's Toolkit	Mon 8/31	3	Making economic decisions: Opportunity cost, rents, and incentives	2.2; 2.8	Quiz 1
	Wed 9/2	4	Why do markets matter? Specialization and comparative advantage	2.3	
	Mon 9/7	Labor Day (campus closed)			
Firms as Price Setters	Wed 9/9	5	Winning brands and the price of Cheerios	7.1–7.2	Quiz 2
	Mon 9/14	6	What does it cost to make a car? Scale and the cost of production	7.3–7.4	
	Wed 9/16	7	Who can get away with raising prices? Demand and elasticity	7.5	
	Mon 9/21	8	Steak, ramen, and recessions: Other elasticities		Quiz 3
	Wed 9/23	9	Sweet spot: Choosing the price and quantity that maximize profit	7.6	
	Mon 9/28	10	The surplus from a sale and who captures it	7.7	Quiz 4
	Wed 9/30	11	Standing out from the crowd: Product differentiation and competition	7.8–7.9	
	Mon 10/5	12	Price wars: Strategic price setting and Nash equilibrium	7.10; 4.2–4.3	Quiz 5
	Wed 10/7	13	Winner takes the market: Natural monopolies and competition policy	7.11–7.12	

Module	Date	Lec.	Topic	Reading	Due
	Mon 10/12	Midterm 1			
Markets with Many Buyers and Sellers	Wed 10/14	14	Classroom market experiment		
	Mon 10/19	15	Cotton, war, and world markets: Supply and demand	8.1–8.2	
	Wed 10/21	16	Taking prices as given: Firms and consumers in competitive markets	8.3–8.4	
	Mon 10/26	17	Who gets what: Allocation, distribution, and the gains from trade	8.5	Quiz 6
	Wed 10/28	18	The quinoa boom: Shifts in supply and demand	8.6	
	Mon 11/2	19	Oil booms and busts: Market dynamics in the short run and long run	8.7–8.10	Quiz 7
	Wed 11/4	20	Salt taxes and rent control: Governments in the market	8.12–8.13	
	Mon 11/9	Midterm 2			
	Wed 11/11	Veterans Day (campus closed)			
Market Successes and Failures	Mon 11/16	21	Bananas, fish, and cancer: Private vs. social value wedge	10.1–10.2	Writing 1
	Wed 11/18	22	Closing the wedge: Property rights, bargaining, and regulation	10.3–10.5	
	Mon 11/23	Fall Recess (no classes)			
	Wed 11/25	Fall Recess (no classes)			
	Mon 11/30	23	Free riders and empty oceans: Public goods and common resources	10.6–10.7	Quiz 8

Module	Date	Lec.	Topic	Reading	Due
	Wed 12/2	24	The limits of markets	10.8–10.11	
Review	Mon 12/7	25	Review and Synthesis I		Writing 2
	Wed 12/9	26	Review and Synthesis II		
	Mon 12/14	Final exam (1:00–2:50 PM)			